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Virginia Board of Education, Lab Schools Standing Committee, Monday, June 10, 2024

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[00:00:04] i'm sorry claire if you can check the waiting room i believe mr hanson may be waiting for us you are now live thank you sir all right well good afternoon my name is joe wadiska i'm the chair of the college partnership laboratory schools standing committee and i want to welcome you all to the june meeting of the standing committee and now call us to order i'd like to note that the standing committee is holding an all virtual public meeting in accordance with section

[00:00:37] 2.2-3708.3 of the code of virginia and the all virtual public meeting policy that was adopted by the virginia state board of education on december 12th 2023 thank you all of you for taking the time to participate in our virtual meeting today and hopefully this format will afford everyone an easier opportunity to participate in the meeting as well as reduce your time and travel expenses they are in. So at this time, Dr. Armstrong, would you be so kind as to please call the role of the members of the standing committee to establish quorum? Yes, ma'am. Mr.

[00:01:14] Bailey, Mr. Hanson, I believe, is on the way. Mr. Rotherham, Vice Chair Dr. Moran. Here. And Chair Wadisca. Present. Thank you, Dr. Armstrong. The members of the standing committee were provided an amended agenda in advance of the meeting. Is there a motion to approve the amended agenda motion to approve is there a second second all those in favor of approving the amended agenda

[00:01:51] please signify by saying aye aye the chair votes aye as well any opposed please indicate by stating a the motion is approved three to zero and now we proceed with our agenda is there a motion to approve the minutes as presented to the standing committee motion to approve the minutes a second second all those in favor of approval of the minutes please signify by stating aye

[00:02:26] chair votes aye as well dr moran did we log your vote aye aye thank you ma'am all right the motion the minutes are are approved thank you so much at this time we are going to go to public comment on agenda items i understand from dr armstrong that we don't have a public comment on any of our agenda items so we're just speeding along in this meeting today we're going to go roll right into item a which i see many happy uh faces and excited to engage in that item this will be first and final

[00:03:01] review of the college partnership laboratory school application from norfolk state university the committee will hear from dr wallace and dr nicholas from norfolk state university followed by a staff report from dr armstrong dr wallace and dr nicholas you'll have up to 10 minutes i believe to make a formal presentation to the committee after which time typically what the committee does is we invite any of your supporters any one that's a partner in your application if they so desire to address the committee at that time then we go

[00:03:38] to dr armstrong for his report and then we come back for questions so just so that everyone kind of has a sense of what to expect we'll hear the official report first from norfolk state we'll hear from all your supporters that are on with us then we'll go to dr armstrong and then we'll do questions from the committee all right with that um dr wallace and dr nicholas we're going to turn the meeting over to you and if you need any assistance from player or comms team to get your slide deck up for the committee to view please don't hesitate to ask it's always a little tricky but so far we've been able to navigate those waters pretty well we have two folks here to

[00:04:17] help you today so thank you i'll turn it over to dr wallace and dr and i'm sorry madam chair i just do want to recognize mr hanson has entered the call as well thank you sir so dr nicholson will will be getting us started with our presentation.

[00:04:34] We thank everyone for coming. - Good afternoon. To Madam Chair, thank you for this opportunity to present the Young Scholars Academy Lab School proposal.

[00:04:54] And a special thank you to Dr. Armstrong and his team for your insight and assistance as we have moved through this process. And so our team consists of colleagues from Norfolk State University, Portsmouth Public Schools, and Norfolk Public Schools. Our work in the Hampton Roads area centered around providing high quality education for our students. We all believe that preparing early learners beginning in pre-K-3 lays the foundation for their scholastic achievement and future rigorous academic pursuits. The impact of this preparation among traditionally marginalized

[00:05:29] populations is most noticeable as early learners need more support from their families. Additionally, these students are underrepresented in gifted education programs and so we believe that if students receive high quality instruction supporting their innate curiosity that by the time they are in grade two they are better prepared for gifted screening the young scholars academy lab school will be a lab school in three locations the NSU preschool academy here on the campus of norfolk state university parkview elementary school in portsmouth and an elementary school to

[00:06:06] to be determined in Norfolk Public Schools. And so we bring before you thinking about why, why this idea, why this idea? So we propose an innovative model to enhance early literacy skills by integrating knowledge of science, technology, arts, engineering, and mathematics known as STEAM.

[00:06:27] We want to encourage the pursuits of curiosity through critical thinking and problem solving skills and to promote connections between STEAM and the real world. We realized that the Virginia Literacy Act requires that every student in kindergarten to grade five will receive core literacy instruction based in scientifically-based reading research and evidence-based literacy instruction.

[00:06:47] So this is the heart of this proposal, making sure that our students receive that type of literacy instruction. Our goal is here to provide early learners with the foundational literacy skills necessary to engage in classroom instruction, to teach critical thinking skills by utilizing STEAM curriculum as the basis access to gifted education, to engage families as partners by providing them with tools to support early learners at home.

[00:07:12] So our mission is to nurture a passion for reading in science, technology, engineering, art, and mathematics. We realize that students cannot go any further if they don't have that foundation. And then we want to address the needs of underserved and low-subsid economic populations by emphasizing early literacy through STEAM exposure. In our area, we have more than 16% of students who live in poverty and so we want to make sure that those students too also receive the services so that their innate abilities can also be recognized and then we want to stimulate

[00:07:46] each child's ability to critically think through experiential learning and of course we know that the research is most important through our collaboration process because we want to make sure that there is developmentally appropriate and culturally relevant instruction delivery practices that we can share with other colleagues across the commonwealth of virginia and the vision of the young scholars academy is to embrace the curiosity of young learners and foster a love of

[00:08:20] reading learning exploration and collaboration to the steam fields the young scholars scholars academy instructional focus is to support literacy as we said earlier to focus on the integration of esteem into the classroom instruction incorporate learning centers and experiential learning for real world connections but we also have this concept of we prepare teacher educators and we want to make sure that our teacher education candidates have a space to explore how learning occurs and how learners construct knowledge and acquire skills we've been able to have successful

[00:08:59] teachers going to the field because of our relationships with porcelain public school and norfolk public schools because they help us to develop our teacher education students to become teachers and we want to make sure these future educators have the understanding of scholarship because we want them to know that they have to make sure that their job is to create a positive learning climate of openness and mutual respect support and inquiry for all students and so as we look at the actual focus. We also take a very good, I mean, thinking deeply about how this works

[00:09:37] and instructional focus is esteem. We want to support literacy instruction to promote a natural curiosity. We want students to be able to see the world around them and we want it to work for them. And we want to also make sure that they have beyond minimal competency, right? We want to encourage young scholars to pursue real world connections. And we know that the outcome will be that we are looking at students who actually can make connections in inquiry, problem-solving, and process-based learning by looking at the models. And so the instructional focus, right,

[00:10:13] as the curriculum is developed by teachers who will incorporate the core skills from Streaming 3, because we'll use that as the basis for our Pre-K 3 and Pre-K 4 students, as we have done in the NSU Preschool Academy, that will continue for pre-K through pre-K-4. But then thinking also how this can actually come together, looking at course skills and the Virginia's 5Cs, as well as the Young Scholars curriculum that will be developed by our partner and teachers who are

[00:10:47] highly qualified. And they will build upon lessons in the science of reading that they have already been practicing and putting together in their school districts and so here's a day a sample schedule in the life of a young scholar academy student you will notice that it has a high literacy concentration because we want to make sure that the basis of the entire day is reading and then you will see how the other subjects flow throughout the day so that students are getting that connection in steam and making sure that that integration is happening organically in the

[00:11:27] classroom as they're being challenged in ways that make them better learners and prepared with a great foundation. And so when we look at the Streaming 3, because this will be an actual foundation in Pre-K 3 through Pre-K 4, as you all know, this was created by the University of Virginia, and it already aligns to the VDOE standards, including the Virginia Kindergarten Readiness Program, the Virginia's Early Learning and Development Standards, as well as the Virginia quality birth to five system. And the assessments that are in that particular program allow us

[00:12:04] to look at instruction so that our students are monitored throughout the process as well as instruction that's created to give them the needed helps that they'll need to continue and to be strong in this particular pursuit. And so at this time, I'll turn it over to Dr. Wallace Alexander, who will move forward with our partners. So we are so blessed and pleased that we have current partners and potential partners that allow us to engage in this STEAM concept. This

[00:12:40] has long been a concept here at Norfolk State University in which we are tapping into what is available around us. We are strongly supported by our university, particularly with our NSU cybersecurity complex, and the plethora of programs that we have that do address STEAM, not to mention the fact that we have a renowned award-winning theater program here at Norfolk State University that our students can also be engaged in. But we have the benefit of location.

[00:13:08] Location, location means everything. And we have looked at several entities that have programs that tap into young learners' curiosities, such as the Virginia Living Museum, the Virginia Air and Space Center, the Hurrah Players, and the Virginia Aquarium, and the Children's Museum of Virginia, which is located in Portsmouth. These are important because our curriculum that we are continuously developing is connected easily to a lot of the curriculum that they have already had and our students continue to experience throughout their compulsory education.

[00:13:43] Next slide. Okay. We find that our impact, one of the big purposes of a lab school is what works in education and identifying that for our pre-service teachers. This impact from pre-K all the way through second grade allows us to not only connect their contact knowledge and increase their ongoing field experience so that they are ready day one when they enter the classroom to provide instructional delivery methods, utilize enhanced assessment skills,

[00:14:20] and have classroom management techniques that meet the needs of all learners. This continuous engagement and action research is to maximize learner success so that they can not only offer whole group instruction, but small group and individualized instruction that allows students to grow and

foster their literacy skills. This strong foundation of literacy enables them to not only embrace their love and curiosity of STEAM, but it also provides them with better access to gifted education that they will be screened for by the time they reach second grade. We are looking

[00:14:56] at projected enrollments across our three campuses as we gradually fold in students each and every year, beginning with 30 students across the three campuses and moving by year four up to 120 students. As you can see, our budget requests 1.2 million in support. If you look at our budget, you will notice that we have incorporated so many components that are necessary for the success of our students. If you want your students to be literate and you want them to have this strong

[00:15:31] foundation, we have recognized that in underserved populations, adequate support and routine screening is necessary in order to provide the individualized instruction, whole group, and small group instruction that is needed to support our young learners and to increase their probability of being able to be critical thinkers and problem solvers. Because we identify that we are looking at four years of support. We have already planned for how we will continue to sustain this endeavor. This endeavor is extremely important to us and for the past 10 years we have been looking at the

[00:16:08] importance of this strong foundation in order to increase access not only to the STEM fields but gifted education and to just make our students more fruitful as they become citizens, grown-up citizens in our environment. We will continue to look at the existing funds that we have here that are supported by norfolk state university already through our preschool academy as well as reallocated funds from our partners of portsmouth public schools as well as norfolk we are one of the areas that we're also looking at is grants which we are strongly supported by individuals who help

[00:16:46] us seek grants to support our endeavors and we are happy to say that partnerships and donors are recognizing the need for this early interventions the need for young scholars to be able to experience a very strong early elementary education that will enable them to have academic success throughout the 12th grade and beyond. And so we thank you for engaging in this overview of our Young Scholars Academy, this lab school partnership with Norfolk State

[00:17:20] University, Portsmouth Public Schools, and Norfolk Public Schools. Thank you for that excellent presentation at this time i'm going to invite any of your supporters or partners or potential partners who might like to address the committee to do so at this time the for those of you who might be interested in addressing the committee the way that we have normally done this is if you state your name the organization you're with and share your thoughts remarks views that you'd like the committee to know and obviously how you might be a partner or may be a partner with the

[00:17:59] applicant that's helpful for us as well so uh dr wallace or dr nicholas if you would like to organize your supporters or if you have a way that you'd like organically or plan to do so i certainly would defer to you well i saw dr birdsong the superintendent for norfolk skills come off mute first so i will start with her and then i would go to the chairman thank you good afternoon everyone i apologize we're having some technical difficulties here so i'm in the room with two of

[00:18:34] my colleagues i appreciate the opportunity to address the committee we are elated with the potential of partnering with norfolk state university and port smith public schools on our young scholars academy we look forward to to working with norfolk state we have done so for many many years and we're just very excited about the option or the opportunity to expand our literacy initiatives and what better way to do that than to focus on our young learners so we

[00:19:08] are certainly appreciative of this opportunity and i would just like you to know that certainly from the leadership we fully support moving forward so thank you again good afternoon i'm dr james pull on the chief academic officer for norfolk public schools and i'd like to echo what dr birdsong said and just add a couple things it really aligns well to in norfolk we have an emerging scholars program for our students to help identify and pull their giftedness out and up for the younger ages if they don't make the qualifying scores and and become gifted in the

[00:19:48] first grade round of assessments so this matches really well with the work we're doing there as as well as with the early literacy. Additionally, starting next year with our ninth graders at Booker T. Washington High School, we're initially getting a STEAM program there. So just connecting all this work we're doing, it was like this fell in our lap at the right time to really help emphasize what we've been doing for the past few years for literacy and STEAM and our giftedness.

[00:20:14] It just is a great connection and I'm looking forward to supporting this on the academic realm with our coordinators specialists as well, as well as our early learning title one program to see what we can do to make it flourish. Good afternoon, everybody. I'm Nicole DeBrees. I'm the chief academic officer for Portsmouth Public Schools. I don't have much to add because like Norfolk, we also have an early scholars program. So we saw the benefit in that and being able to really target those students

[00:20:54] who we know have the ability, just haven't had the opportunity. We are heavily focused on our early literacy, especially, and thinking about the alignment to the programs we already have in place, and also the continued reciprocal partnership between Norfolk State and Portsmouth schools.

[00:21:12] We see the value in continuing that. It also provides us with a pipeline for applicants, as well as a pipeline for developing highly qualified teachers and increasing their expertise because we know when they have an increase in confidence and professional efficacy that their classroom practices become better as well. So we are supportive of this endeavor and look forward to the partnership. Thank you. Good afternoon. My name is Dr. Cardio Cotillo. I'm the board chair for Portsmouth City School Board. I would like to first say thank you to the committee for the opportunity

[00:21:49] to participate during today's presentation. As stated many times, I thought Lisa Coons, our state superintendent. Literacy is our greatest civil right, and it is encouraging to know that everyone on this call has the same shared vision, which is to create an educational environment that not only fosters academic excellence, but also cultivates a spirit of inquiry and a passion of lifelong learning. As a school board, it is our sincere belief that by bringing together these resources, expertise, and enthusiasm of our educational institutions, we are poised to transform this vision into reality. So I'd like to extend my heartfelt gratitude to the staff of

[00:22:25] norfolk state university forces public schools and norfolk public schools will work tirelessly to make this partnership a reality their dedication vision and heart work are the foundations on which we will build a brighter future for virginia students it is our hope that we're able to move forward with this wonderful opportunity and that the strength this partnership will further display our shared commitment to excellence innovation and collaboration together we will create an educational environment that will not only meet the needs of virginia students today but also prepare them to thrive and ever change the world of tomorrow thank you again so much for your time

[00:22:59] good afternoon everyone i am aurelia william the senior vice provost here at norfolk state university and i just want to take a moment to add to what everyone else has said is this is an indeed a

unique opportunity for norfolk state university in partnership with both portsmouth public school and norfolk public schools and we look to the opportunity of really

[00:23:37] impact in our community and providing resources for our students so that they can get identified as early as K-3 and K-4 as obtaining schools that will allow them to move into gifted curriculum that is already established within our school partners. For Norfolk State University, the ability to modify elevate our existing preschool this was the prime opportunity for us to leverage the resources that have been developed throughout the state of virginia and to work with our

[00:24:16] community partners to make a difference so we are excited to be here glad to have submitted our application and look forward to a favorable response thank you dr wallace dr necklace should we, Nicholson, excuse me, should we expect any additional speakers regarding your application?

[00:24:53] I think we left it open just in case anyone else wanted to say anything. Ms. Buffalo, would you like to add in your role as the chair, and Dr. Bracey, please feel free, sir. Yes. Well, good afternoon, everyone. I'm just going to echo what everyone else has said. I think this is a great opportunity for Horsmith Public Schools and Norfolk Public Schools, along with Norfolk state partner with norfolk state um in this endeavor i support the application wholeheartedly

[00:25:27] and on behalf of the school board of norfolk public schools we are delighted and cannot wait to see the outcomes of this partnership with norfolk state university thank you i guess look everything has been said i echo what my colleague dr bird song has shared yeah we look forward to this opportunity i want to thank norfolk state university for allowing us the opportunity to be a part of this we definitely see a significant benefit that will be afforded to

[00:26:04] our students and our staff in that regard so we just look forward to the opportunity and hopefully this receives positive feedback so we can proceed thank you we thank all of our supporters um thank you for igniting the light underneath our feet to really inspire us to reach for the stars thank you for seeing our vision and our mission and how we want to impact our young learners and our communities and we thank you for your support you're very modest people but we thank you so much for all of your support and all of your guidance in putting this application

[00:26:43] together um dr nicholson dr williams and i could not have gotten this far without you so thank you very much and we look forward to this partnership and really positively impacting the lives of our young scholars thank you and thank you for taking the time to come before the committee today the committee truly and sincerely appreciates not only your participation in today's meeting and the testimonials for which you've provided but more importantly your engagement in the application and then collaboration and partnership with your with the northwest state university so at this

[00:27:21] time i'm going to go to dr armstrong who's going to provide a staff report and then we'll go to questions from the committee members. Thank you, Madam Chair. Madam Chair and committee members, I would like to provide a brief overview on behalf of the VDOE on the Norfolk State University Young Scholars Academy lab school application. The NSU Young Scholars will provide a unique early learners and pre-k focused lab school. This is the first application we have seen from the VDOE for a pre-k focus, which would begin on site at the Bowser Building on the campus of Norfolk State University, which is the site of the current NSU Child Development Center for three- and

[00:27:58] four-year-olds, and then grow into a K-1 program on-site at individual school locations in both the Norfolk and Portsmouth public school systems. The focus of the NSU Young Scholars Academy will be to increase educational development and access among underrepresented students using a STEM curriculum and learner-centered approach focused on literacy and gift education standards.

[00:28:19] The NSU Young Scholars Academy Lab School seeks to enhance early literacy skills by integrating knowledge of science, technology, arts, engineering, and mathematics, STEAM, as connections to their daily lives. Providing students with foundational skills, along with family support, will allow them to gain instruction to reinforce robust academic development. Furthermore, by partnering with two school districts to meet the needs of early learners, the Young Scholars Academy Lab School will become a space for educator training and recruitment. NSU teacher education students and candidates will have the opportunity to work as tutors and apply their content knowledge to classroom environments.

[00:28:55] This will allow them to strengthen their skills in lesson planning, differentiating instruction, creating culturally responsive learning environments, and utilizing assessment data to foster learning and academic success for young learners. Our review of the NSU application has included multiple rounds of subject matter expert feedback, including targeted review from the VDOE Office of Early Childhood Care and Education.

[00:29:16] Multiple calls were held between VDOE and the NSU team prior to and subsequent application submission, and the NSU team has been responsive and inquisitive as they have thoughtfully adjusted their plan based on VDOE and feedback from the Office of the Attorney General as well. As you will see in the attached completeness and compliance report, for the purposes of our standing committee review today, the NSU Young Scholars Program is ready to implement in the elements of executive summary, mission, vision, governance, management structure, financial and operational information, placement plan, and other assurances and requirements. Under educational program, we do note that additional clarity is needed to determine compliance with Virginia SOQ

[00:29:54] requirements as related to the proposed lab school site at Norfolk State University, site of a three to four-year-old program in year one. While lab schools embedded within existing public schools, such as supports within Norfolk locations of the Young Scholars Program, typically benefit from the many associated services of the local K-12 school division and provision of many of those statutory and SOQ requirements, the agency hopes to collaborate further with the applicant to establish compliance for the NSU location. Given that the NSU application is our first pre-K proposal, technical assistance moving forward will be specialized and critical to ensuring compliance.

[00:30:28] I stand prepared to answer any questions of the committee at this time. Thank you, Dr. Armstrong, for that report as well as for the subject matter experts review and legals review of the application. At this time, I'll go to members of the committee for their questions for the applicant. Dr. Moran, I see that you are off mute. I'll go to you first.

[00:30:48] Thank you, Chair Wadiska. I just want to say that I applaud you for going after something that we have not seen yet, which is a focus on early childhood education. And Dr. Bracey, Dr. Birdsong, as myself, a former superintendent in Virginia, all of us, I think, really understand that the earlier that we can start to intervene and support and accelerate learning and build background knowledge with very young children, the more likely they're going to have a successful trajectory, not just through elementary school, but all the way through high school, graduate, and into life.

[00:31:25] So it's great to see the support from the two school divisions here, as well as from Norfolk State, which has a pretty comprehensive, if I've looked at your curriculum, a pretty comprehensive early childhood education teacher prep program. The first place that I wanted to start is at that place of teacher preparation because the other thing that I'm aware of, and I'd love to have you comment on this as a part of my question, but we know that one of the key purposes of a lab school is to make sure that as many teachers as you have in your pre-service programs get an

[00:32:02] opportunity to have a deep experience in understanding how to not just learn about early childhood education in seat time classes, but to have direct experiences in the field in a program like this so that when they go out into schools, that they are far better prepared to take on early childhood classrooms, whether it's PK, K, first grade, second grade, which I think all fit within my spectrum of early childhood. So I'd love to know a little bit more about how you plan to bring pre-service teachers in, what you see that comprehensive experience as being like,

[00:32:42] what kinds of things you would expect them to do, and about how many teachers that you would plan to move through the STEAM program through the academy. Second to that is something that I know about the two school divisions, and that is that you both have high school CTE programs for aspiring teachers that are in your high schools right now. I would love to know whether there is maybe some sense of how even high school students that are in those academies that both Portsmouth

[00:33:20] and Norfolk City has, how they might also be pulled in and get a leg up on being able to have these experiences as well. So, if you could just tell me a little bit more about the training program for inside the academy for Norfolk State pre-service teachers, but then also about the potential recruitment piece of that out of the high schools in Norfolk and Portsmouth. So, Dr.

[00:33:53] Nicholson, do you want to start? Yes, your question excites me, Dr. Moran, because that's the heart of of what we do in preparing teachers. And so at our present, in the present program for early childhood and elementary education, students go through a three practicum experience.

[00:34:11] The very first practicum experience happens in the Foundations class, which is Educational 201. And students have the opportunity at that time to do the observation in a setting. And so by having the setting that we're talking about here with the Young Scholars Academy, our students will actually have that experience along with their instructor, their professor, to look at the entire standards and to look at ways that they see the learning environment.

[00:34:41] And so that is really a big deal for us because we want them to be excited about the work early on. And we believe this will happen in this context. And then secondly, when they get to the point of the second practical experience, they also have to do more hours, but this time they get to work in small groups, right?

[00:34:58] They get to work with the students, and they also are looking at learning development, but they also learn about differentiating of instruction, right? And so this is the opportunity for them to work together in this lab school space, both in our campus as well as our two partners, school districts.

[00:35:17] And then finally, of course, with student teaching by them, we've sold them, and they pretty much know where they want to go. And if they're in this experience throughout the trajectory of their experience as a student teacher, I mean, a teacher education student, then they are more likely to want to continue in this work.

[00:35:37] And so we're excited about that opportunity. The second thing that you asked had to do with the CTE programs, aspiring educators, both in the two school districts. And so currently we work with a program called Educators Rising, but we have already been to have conversations of how we can help our partner school districts to think about these programs. We would love to have those students in their programs to look at this lab school as their place of observation and to talk with them more about the profession because we truly believe

[00:36:13] that if students have a good foundation in what education is, they will not just come to the profession for a year or two, but they will stay and they will understand the work that we do. And so, Dr. Wallace, you want to add anything or we go? In conjunction with what you asked, Dr. Moran, we also have been very instrumental over the past three years in getting our methods classes and some of our other classes to actually occur within a school. So we have been so

[00:36:46] graciously welcome, particularly in Norfolk Public Schools, by those principals who allow our professors to come and conduct their class at least once a week in an actual classroom so that they get the experience of, you're in a classroom management class, this is how this is managed.

[00:37:06] Let's watch the teacher do it and then you try the same thing in a small group. And so we are expanding these field experiences to enable our students to be, like I said earlier, to be first day ready when they walk into the classroom and have these experiences. Our close proximity to so many of the schools that fit the population that we're trying to tap into allows us that opportunity to have our students in all of our teacher preparation programs engage in these endeavors. And by having this on our campus, we already have students in all of our programs who already provide hours outside of and this is volunteer on their part and this is the heart of

[00:37:46] norfolk state university where service to our community is something that we discuss on a regular basis so even outside of their regular classroom assignments they still give volunteer hours to the preschool academy so that they get more experience of what it is like working with young scholars and so these are some things that we will continue to have for our students moving forward thank you thank you if i can add really quick to dr moran's question on the cte side of it with norfolk public schools our our largest teacher prepper program is actually held at a

[00:38:24] pre-k center in our norfolk technical center so this is a great match and we developed a couple years ago a pathway for our graduates to become pre-k paraprofessionals and we've actually hired a couple of them over the past couple years so any field experience that we can have we look for so this will definitely be a great match for what we have in place right now i love it it's it's a it's a great uh use of the pipeline model so i really appreciate that and it's great to know you have that preschool center right there at your cte center too um i have one more question if it's

[00:38:59] okay or i can wait dr with us please proceed the other question that i had is that i know that that registering students and getting kids into preschool programs really is time-consuming.

[00:39:15] There's so much that has to go along with that. But I'm wondering about, I know that you described a process for how you will find students, get them into doing an application, and I know you're going to have to work with families on that, and then being able to really sort of timestamp applications as they come in. I also know that the lab school law specifies that it will be an open lottery, that all the students go into the hopper, and then you basically pull

[00:39:51] out applications to fill your slots. How do you see this reconciling, the difference between the lottery model that our lab schools are supposed to use and the model of taking applications in order, timestamping them, and using that as a mechanism for getting kids into the program?

[00:40:13] Or is that something you think you still need to work some with the agency on to get that sorted out? So I know that this is a conversation that we've had. As you said, Dr. Murman, we've operated differently in the past, but we will move to the lottery system. We look at it as a good change, Right. Something that we can do to offer this education to more students.

[00:40:39] And we will work with the agency to make sure that our process is alignment and that it is fair across the board. But we are excited about the change and we look forward to the opportunity. Thank you. Thank you, Dr.

[00:40:55] Moran. At this time, I'll go to Mr. Hansen or Mr. Gabley for questions. Mr. Hansen, would you like to go first? Sure. Well, number one, just thank you, Dr. Williams and Dr. Nicholson and Dr. Wallace-Alexander and everybody.

[00:41:14] I just really appreciate the vision and the thoughtfulness and the obvious collective work and partnership that's been put into this proposal and just very intrigued by it. So just thank you for your vision and your work in putting this together.

[00:41:33] And I actually just had a couple of questions and maybe dovetailing on Dr. Moran's question If you could just help me, obviously, by being an early childhood pipeline of students, just in terms of maybe identifying a little bit more clearly the intended population and also just the community outreach or the marketing that might need to be associated with this and just maybe what are some of the key characteristics that you're really looking for,

[00:42:13] not just in the first year, but as the program matures into kind of its full bloom, how would you feel like what does success look like? So let me tackle the first part when you talk about population. So we are very well aware of the underrepresentation of certain populations in gifted education. We are also very aware of the numbers when it comes to literacy and reading

[00:42:48] among populations across the state of Virginia. And so we are really trying to target those particular aspects. And so when we look at this program and we are seeking to market it, one of the things that we feel is very strong about our partnerships with our school divisions is that there's a strong marketing component there. We have a wonderful School of Education advisory board, which has representation of these school divisions. So we get the word out there we also have wonderful resources here on the campus of norfolk state university

[00:43:23] that enables us as you know we have radio station we have many productions as a matter of fact our campaign just for the school won an award so we are very much capable of marketing to the populations that we seek because of the nature of this institution over the last 80 some years we are very tapped into the communities and so we are constantly present you can't throw a stone without hearing somebody say behold the green and gold um anywhere throughout hampton roads and so all we really have to do is wear a norfolk state university shirt with our little

[00:44:03] school of education emblem and people ask us questions we attend town halls we attend meetings we are very hands-on individuals here in the school of education and helping individuals understand this is what we're trying to do and why we're trying to do it. And this is who we're trying to do it

for. We really want to tap into those communities who normally don't have a great feeling about being heard and seen. And so I think that this is a great opportunity for us to get them to really embrace what we are trying to do and how it benefits their youth. And I think that this particular endeavor really taps into those young children where all parents want to see

[00:44:42] success and because we have such a strong community engagement and really embrace parental involvement we are able to give parents the tools that is a component of our application as well as providing parents with the support to be able to support their young scholars as they go on so we're looking at building when we say building a foundation we are really looking at a a ground level foundation building process here in which we are hands-on with our communities thank you

[00:45:14] dr wallace alexander just another question on just the um the timing of the opening and also just um understand kind of maybe what year one would look like but again uh uh maybe with the multiple locations with the two districts um schools just maybe helping me um have a clearer picture of maybe when you're a little bit more at full throttle and how um will the distribution of

[00:45:46] students look like and how many students would be in each site, and what would be the types of transportation or other needs that might be before the districts.

[00:46:04] So we were going to have conversations already with that, Dr. Hanson. We looked at our current pre-K-3 and pre-K-4 here house on the campus of Norfolk State University for year one. will be open for Norfolk Public Schools, who is our closest, to actually bus students to us.

[00:46:25] Dr. Pol, we talked with that and we talked about, hey, this is ideal. We sit in the middle of Norfolk. And so it works in our world. And so that will happen year one for actual students. Also in that year, it will be a planning year for K, kindergarten, and first grade because the curriculum still needs to be written out. Our colleagues and partners at Portsmouth Public school have already begun to write curriculum in the science of reading. We will build on that so that we actually have curriculum and assessments that we'll be writing in year one so that in year two, the other locations on the school apart from the elementary, as well as the school that Norfolk

[00:47:03] public schools would identify would do kindergarten and first grade. And so year one solely on the Norfolk State University campus with students from Norfolk public schools being able to come to our campus, the transportation from them, and then in kindergarten and first grade, those two years will be written with curriculum and assessments that are aligned with our standards here in the Commonwealth of Virginia, and they will be implementing year two, three, and four.

[00:47:33] Sure. My last question is really just on the, I appreciate the conversation on the curriculum from just maybe a little bit further clarity on if they're if this is going to be developed or already approved list of curriculum that would be used for the students so for pre-k 3 or pre-k 4 we are already using the approved curriculum of streaming 3 that was created by uva in alignment with virginia department education standards for early learners and we will continue that

[00:48:12] because it's an amazing curriculum. It does everything we need it to do. It includes STEAM and the whole nine yards. And so we're excited about our colleagues at UVA for bringing that to fruition for all of us to use. The curriculums in kindergarten and first grade will have a STEAM approach. We will look at current, of course, Virginia Department of Education standards of learning, and we'll continue to write on

top of that with a STEAM approach. So that will be modified so that it includes that steam approach. Thank you, Dr. Nicholson. Thank you, sir. Thank

[00:48:49] you, Mr. Hanson. Mr. Bailey. Thank you. Excuse me. Thank you so much. Thanks for the time today and for walking us through this and for all the thoughtfulness you put into the application. I just wanted to double click on something that Pam just mentioned about the admissions process.

[00:49:10] And I know we were just wrestling through some aspects with the lottery, but it's one of the And one of the main themes that I think was very prevalent through both your presentation as well as the application is making sure that the, that this is culturally responsive.

[00:49:25] And I wonder if you could just talk a little bit more about how you'll help sort of promote this opportunity for people to go into the admissions process. You'll you'll do the community outreach and and bring people into the pipeline for this, just to help them explore that this is a good opportunity for them and for their kids.

[00:49:43] And before it even gets to kind of that that lottery system. I just curious how you do the outreach and the recruitment for this. Well, we have outreach endeavors already. As I previously said, we have a school of education advisory board that has shared this information in their school districts with their individuals.

[00:50:06] mention the fact we have a pretty good marketing team here at norfolk state university many of our different university partnerships include many of our business partners churches community organizations and the like and so we have access to a plethora of entities to get our message out about um this program our vision and our mission um we are very much engaged in um several of our professional organizations as well and because of that we are able to also put the information out

[00:50:42] that in that way um we are always present at um numerous uh civic social um and educational events which also allows us a platform in order to share and not to mention our partners are very good about sharing within their school districts as you can see we have the support of school board members as well as superintendents and chief academic officers that are also instrumental in providing us with opportunities to engage with their constituents with the parents and the students to get this message out and share what the vision and mission is and how to apply and why

[00:51:21] this may be of interest to parents in the communities that we are trying to provide this particular um experience and mr bailey just to add our office of academic affairs continues we have mous that we can leverage and so we have mouser each one of the school districts and so we can continue that route as well but then ideals about hosting an open house have come in so we will truly work with the department to make sure that we have a marketing campaign that is fair and equitable so that students and their families across our area will have the opportunity to learn

[00:52:00] about the lab school before we start with the lottery process and so we're just very we're very excited that we have so many entities you know academic affairs norfolk public schools personal public schools that you know we will sit at the table and we will come up with a true definitive way to do it so it's equitable but of course you know the leading with the department and dr armstrong we will go back and make sure that it's correct mr bailey did you

[00:52:32] have anything further sir no thank you well i certainly want to share my enthusiasm and excitement when we received this application it was really just so delightful to see a partnership really

focused on young scholars and for our earliest learners uh and i love that you reached into the three and four year olds i mean and really are dialing in on how to create a seamless transition for them with the public schools um i had a wonderful experience in my own local community

[00:53:11] uh helping create these bridges and the value that it creates not only for the child but for family engagement and support is it the benefits continue to to show throughout an academic experience for a young learner who eventually becomes a graduate so i want to thank you and it's harder when you're working with young learners there are more compliance requirements on little ones and there's more agencies involved and more rules that is something certainly that

[00:53:45] makes this population that much more complicated to serve but you've taken on that effort and for that i compliment you because you're the first one um when i'm listening to the other committee members and and as we've reviewed your application and i think i've sent over some of my our questions that i had in advance of today's uh consideration i sincerely hear your not only your passion and collaboration with one another but your willingness to work with the virginia department of education noting that this population is a little trickier to serve because of all those compliance elements

[00:54:25] what i think we might be inclined to do at this point is to further refer your application back to bdoe for further technical assistance support and coaching um i've kept kind of a list of what those elements are and i can certainly i'll put that down in a moment but i kind of want to walk you through what we're thinking about in terms of a process so if you've been following our work i think you may have noted that we have had a number of applications that have come before the committee on compliance issues and we have referred those applications back to bdoe for

[00:55:02] further technical assistance and support and coaching it's really been an important consideration for the committee um we're not trying to make us into a high stakes environment of yes or no we really want to help our applicants uh not only uh it really work help our applicants get to yes and fulfill the statutory compliance mechanisms and sometimes that's really tricky um when we have worked with our applicants to do so i'm proud to say that because of the great support from bdoe every applicant that's been referred back has come back before the committee

[00:55:39] has been referred by this committee to the state board of education has and has ultimately been approved and so i i want to assure you that the support that you can receive from the agency is collaborative and they're there to assist you so if what i've kind of heard from the committee members um and at this time i'm going to kind of put into the record would be that on behalf of the committee i would direct video we need to work with northlake state university to provide additional coaching and technical support in the following areas a plan to include pre-service teachers

[00:56:15] uh soq compliance for either a standalone program or a program a standalone school or a program or in this case both as you may have it the lottery process including enrollment marketing and the enrollment the academic programs and transportation i have not asked a question about sustainability but i will put that into this as well so for sustainability just to get more information and detail into your application um and upon any further refinement and amendments that are made to your application you can submit those uh to the committee and the committee will consider

[00:56:54] your application on final review and take it up the next opportunity and one last uh close i want to make on this and we've had this with a number of our applicants there's not a shot clock above your head um i understand the committee understands that this is very hard work and we're not expecting

it to be expedient it's more valuable that it's quality work so if it takes you a month or two months or six months that is acceptable and if at any point that you should decide that you do not want to proceed with an application of course an applicant retains that ability at any point

[00:57:30] in the process as well and so really the next step you would be driving the timelines they are not driven for you you get to have full choice and discretion as to how you work on the application and how it's involved. So that's kind of been the deliberation. I'm going to just stop there for a moment, see Dr. Wallace or Dr. Nicholas, should you have any questions? And I know that you know Dr. Armstrong and he's going to be a great partner in your work, but I do want to just see if you

[00:58:00] have any questions at this time. I don't know if it's necessarily a question as more of a thought and how exactly we proceed forward. So the timeline of, you know, when we would receive everything that we need to do and then what's next for us to be able to submit to, you know, get this program off the ground.

[00:58:33] Absolutely. So the items that we've just identified where the committee needs further information, you as the applicants would work to develop out, build out more details around those elements, you would do that in collaboration with Dr. Armstrong.

[00:58:52] For those areas where there's a compliance question, we can also, staff can also engage the Office of Attorney General on items like SOQ and just help you understand those compliance items in further detail. Once those items are sufficiently answered for VDOE and the Office of Attorney General, amended application would be submitted back to the committee and at that time we would call a

[00:59:23] meeting and consider your application so um yeah i really want to emphasize that you know you can feel confident to take as much time as you so desire um we've had some applicants that they took six months to further work out details on their application some took just a few weeks um but we don't want to set that requirement over your head as to when. Is that sufficient or do you have a further question about that? I do want to make sure that you feel comfortable with that.

[01:00:03] For now, that's sufficient. I'm sure I'll probably have other questions as time goes on. Dr. Nicholas, I think you had a question as well. I want to say thank you, Madam Chair, and to the committee members for your questions on today.

[01:00:19] It helps us to think through those pieces. As you can tell, we're really excited about the ideal so we will work forward to make sure this works out our partners are amazing and we believe that what we're doing is truly going to impact the lives of young learners in our area as well as their families so thank you for the opportunity to discuss this thank you we look forward to seeing you at a future meeting all right at this time we are going to proceed then with item b before we do so however uh excuse me for just one moment here prior to the consideration

[01:00:56] of item b i'm going to turn the virtual gavel over to our committee vice chair dr pamela moran i will be going off camera as well and i will rejoin the meeting upon the conclusion of item b i serve on the board of directors for the virginia spaceflight academy which is a partner in the upcoming item b virginia spaceflight academy is where our daughter attended and graduated and therefore i'm going to refuse myself from the consideration of this item before the committee Dr. Rand. Thank you, Dr. Wieska. So we appreciate everyone that's with us here today, both from the

[01:01:35] Norfolk State application, and it's a highly important one. Excited about it and look forward to you coming back after some of those compliance details have been worked out with the department. But now I want to turn to the ODU application, the Aerospace Academy of the Eastern Shore Lab school, AAES for short. And what we're going to be doing is beginning with saying thank you for being here. And I believe that we have Dr. Sanzo, Dr. Reed and Maggie Barber with us from ODU. And what

[01:02:10] we're going to do is to invite you as a starting point to tell us about your application. You've got a presentation that you'll be bringing up. And then what we will be doing is giving then anyone else here that has an interest in speaking to the ODU application to have an opportunity to do that. And we will also have Dr. Armstrong provide his report. So I presume I need to turn it over to Dr. Sanzo first to begin to share with us the ODU application on AAES lab

[01:02:46] school. Yes, thank you. I'll go ahead and share my presentation. See my notes. Hang on one second. Okay, I think that should work now. Is that correct? Okay, super great. Thank you very much.

[01:03:10] Good afternoon, Chair Wadiska and members of the Standing Committee, Dr. Kuntz and colleagues joining us today. I'm Karen Sanzo, Director of the Institute for Design Thinking and Leadership Development at ODU. I'm appreciative to my partners joining me here today to share about lab school proposal the aerospace academy of the eastern shore i'm joined here in our formal presentation by dr phil reid professor in the department of educational leadership and workforce development in the darden college of education and professional studies and dr maggie barber associate dean for educator preparation and assessment and i need to figure out there we go

[01:03:45] next slide virginia is a burgeoning home to the aerospace industry and the state's aerospace and and Unbanned Systems Industry Workforce is projected to grow by 8.5% during the next decade. And the establishment of the Aerospace Academy on the Eastern Shore, where the poverty rate exceeds 40% in the past two decades have seen an aging and decreasing population can significantly contribute to the region's economic growth.

[01:04:10] An educated and trained workforce can help bring aerospace supply chain businesses to the Eastern Shore. And this is a strategic response to a critical workforce need in our community. we are directly aligning with regional economic trends and job market demands. Our educational approach for the Aerospace Academy is aligned with our lab school approach and continues with our focus on an innovative and research supported design. In partnership with our districts, education, industry, and other partners, we plan to utilize student-guided learning, STEM integration, and experiential learning to equip students with the skills needed for high

[01:04:47] demand aerospace industry jobs. The mission is to provide at-risk and our underrepresented populations access to the knowledge skills abilities needed to be successful in aerospace and adjacent industries and our vision is that this will be an innovative interdisciplinary school and the regional standard of excellence in preparation for the high-tech aerospace fields so the sample schedule that dr reed is going to discuss will show you how students day at the aerospace academy would be structured and what it would look like students who have been admitted

[01:05:22] through an open lottery system using the school mint enrollment system will attend the academy from their home school and they will have in-person and virtual courses throughout their school experience students will have opportunities to engage in site visits and other experiential learning opportunities in order to engage with and be prepared for aerospace industry careers educational

partners include the virginia space grant consortium the virginia flight academy and others as you can see in our application and those who will be speaking today so not only will students in the lab school participate in courses specifically related to aerospace during their academic day they'll also have opportunities to participate in summer experiences and we plan to

[01:06:00] provide all students the opportunity to attend at least one summer camp through the virginia space flight academy during their lab school experience as well as participate annually in aerospace educational modules from the virginia space flight academy and partnering with the virginia space grant consortium to work with their educational modules as well and dr reed is going to share about the curriculum. Thank you, Dr. Sanzo. So you can see here the AAES Academy has two pathways, aerospace information and security systems or aerospace engineering and exploration.

[01:06:39] And additionally, you can see in the aerospace engineering and exploration pathway, students can specialize in aerospace engineering and computer science or in unmanned aircraft and geospatial technology and we'll talk a little bit about each of the pathways and the grade levels here so in grade nine the english language arts class will focus on ethics and engineering and technology so that'll focus on uh you know professionalism of engineers as well as working

[01:07:15] with clients and other constituents students will also take an introduction to aerospace engineering and design course. In grade 10 students will take honors courses in English language arts and biology and they will further their design skills in a technical drawing and design course.

[01:07:36] Students in the AAES lab school will have the opportunity to participate as Dr. Sanzo said in the Virginia Space Flight Academy which contains online modules a STEM academy and a space adventure camp among other activities both during the year and during the summer next slide please thank you in grade 11 students will begin taking engineering and computer science courses that are specific to their pathway in both pathways students will be encouraged to take electives in the virginia

[01:08:15] aerospace and technology scholars program and otherwise known as vats the vats program is offered by the Virginia Space Grant Consortium, students will have spots in those classes.

[01:08:30] They will not have to apply to get in those Space Grant Consortium classes. In grade 12, students will complete a capstone project, an internship, and are encouraged to take electives in the Virginia Earth System Science Scholars, or VES program.

[01:08:54] VEST program is offered by the Virginia Space Grant Consortium and like the VATS program, students will have spots in there as well. So this figure illustrates how the core classes and pathway courses are designed to foster 21st century skills and students' interest in STEM careers. The instructional focus is on tackling authentic problems through active learning, such as design challenges internships and capstone projects great thank you and i'd like to point out

[01:09:34] the similarities in these designs across our lab school so that we're able to cultivate this lab school network where we're able to bring teachers directors and partners together so that we're able to learn iteratively through our research and scale up as we move forward we have a number of different college and career opportunities for our students during the design phase of our proposed school we've had an opportunity to connect with different industry professionals to ideate around powerful learning experiences and we'll continue to do this in the upcoming year the students will have that opportunity to

earn dual enrollment credits from eastern shore community college and we also have an opportunity to have odu specific credits we're designing the school in

[01:10:11] a way that provides students with work-based experiences we're very excited about our partnerships and collaborations that we've already established and opportunities to network with potential employers. The students will leave the academy college career and citizen ready, contributing to a thriving aerospace industry. And the academy represents our commitment to our students' futures, our commitment to our community's economic health, and helping to cultivate Virginia's aerospace industry. And so we have the number of industry partners that are here. And then looking ahead, we are going to use this upcoming year to continue to collaborate

[01:10:49] and iterate around the design to have 50 students coming in in the freshman year again through this open lottery that we're able to host their school met with the application process and then each subsequent year bringing in additional students so that we have 100 students eventually annually that are a part of this i'm going to turn this over to dr barber to speak around teacher preparation and development thank you dr sanzo we are pleased to partner with eastern shore community college in Acomac and Northampton Public Schools on the Aerospace Academy of the Eastern Shore on creating and supporting a continuum of teacher preparation and professional development.

[01:11:26] This proposal reflects work that's already underway in creating scalable and sustainable strategies for recruiting, preparing, retaining, and sustaining high quality teachers in our community's high needs schools and divisions. It further reflects ODU's commitment to creating affordable pathways to developing high quality teacher preparation to meet the specific needs of each of our divisions. These efforts parallel our efforts across our lab school networks to better support scale and expansion of this work throughout the region. The first prong of this is a regional approach in the Tidewater and Eastern Shore communities that uses teacher residencies and

[01:12:01] teacher apprenticeships, drawing actively on the workforce of paraprofessionals in our partner schools. We know that paraprofessionals have already demonstrated their interest and commitment in working in schools, including high-need schools. They're familiar with the requirements in the day-to-day work in those classrooms they are more likely to reflect the diversity of the students in their k-12 classrooms and they are already largely members of the communities of the members of the communities that they serve we will work with eastern shore community college and tidewater community college as appropriate to support paraprofessionals in completing their associate's degrees and odu will support them to complete their bachelor's degrees with licensure

[01:12:38] and critical shortage areas such as elementary education and special education by doing so we're investing not only in the capacity of schools to meet the needs of all children but we're also investing in the workforce development and economic opportunities for paraprofessionals who currently earn low wages for their work in schools we are excited by the potential to scale this work up and anticipate being able to start with as many as 90 in our first cohort and scale well beyond that to meet the needs of our school divisions to this end we've already begun our efforts to support these programs we have a long-standing teacher residency program in the the Hampton Roads that we will be expanding to include our partners in this next round

[01:13:16] of funding to include our divisions in the Eastern Shore. We will be seeking funding to the next round of VDOE teacher residency funding this summer. We have also already begun our work on

establishing a Region 2 Teacher Apprenticeship Consortium to support the region's preparation of paraprofessionals to be fully licensed.

[01:13:36] We've submitted a $1.3 million congressional appropriations proposal to support this effort and we're excited to share that we've heard last week that Senators Warner and Kane have advanced this proposal to the Senate Appropriations Committee for a decision later this summer.

[01:13:52] This work would address instructional costs and help us establish this program to move it forward. We are also preparing a proposal through VDOE to establish a regional apprenticeship program. Last week, we supported a US Department of Ed Teacher Quality Partnership proposal to support mentor training and induction components of this program throughout the region to ensure effective transfer of learning from preparation into practice.

[01:14:14] Again, to focus not only on preparing excellent educators, but to ensure they stay in the communities that they were prepared in to meet those needs. We've also submitted a proposal to the National Center for Teacher Residencies to support the needs of teacher candidates from underrepresented communities.

[01:14:30] Throughout this work, we're looking for sustainable models that rely on existing division and university resources, knowing that we need to reduce the cost of teacher preparation and increasing the pipeline. In addition to these efforts with preparing new teachers, we're also developing an ODU lab school network professional development hub that will support the work across our lab schools.

[01:14:50] To provide focused teacher professional development to build and extend teacher capacity and innovative pedagogical practices aligned specifically with the mission of the school. And then finally, for the last component, we will be providing educator professional development through the Virginia Space Grant Consortium to ensure close integration between teacher practice and the aerospace focus. Thank you. Great. Thank you. In addition to the professional development educator hub, we also are expanding our research efforts and having a research hub.

[01:15:23] So we're also able to learn across our lab school network and scale up as well. The research model is aligned with our other schools using a design-based implementation approach that integrates faculty public school educators business and industry experts and others for designing and testing our educational innovations using evidence to make decisions that positively support student learning and evidence that contributes for continuous improvement model and promote sustainability one of the unique elements for this lab school proposal is the way in which we work across multiple school systems and multiple high schools in order to design and implement an innovative lab school model our research around scheduling innovative learning

[01:16:02] design and collaboration across divisions will be an important part of our research and evaluation approach our budget represents a need to provide innovative and robust educational programming for students including summer learning experiences experiential learning and in-person and virtual learning opportunities we also anticipate needing to spend focused amounts of time around curriculum development learning design and designing or implementation of the programming. We're also excited to be able to provide students the opportunity to earn dual enrollment credits without cost to them or the school divisions. Because of the uniqueness of this learning design,

[01:16:39] we'll intend to bring in different learning partners and those learning partners will help us as we iterate around our curriculum design and instructional approach. Our lab school network design has focused squarely on sustainability. We believe that we have designed and put forward very sustainable models for our laboratory schools as shared previously odio has a strong history of sustainability of initiatives leveraging our research to demonstrate the innovations we want to continue to pursue grants or as you've already heard from dr barber about our robust work around educator preparation and we have had

[01:17:14] over a decade of ongoing grant funding we've already begun discussions with potential partners to explore the ways in which they can assist with our sustainability efforts we continue to work with our development office and to create a robust development approach odu also has committed to investing in our lab school efforts this includes providing personnel resources fiscal commitments and other resources such as facilities and technology in order to help ensure the sustainability of our lab schools my next slide is a thank you here we go i just want to thank you all for the

[01:17:49] opportunity to present and just thank you to our partners with Acomac and Northampton. I am particularly excited about the possibility of working again on the eastern shore having already had a federal grant earlier on in my career and I just know that it's such an amazing location and great partners and so thank you as well for your work on this. So thank you and we do have a number of people here who are joining us to express their commitment um if we're okay to introduce them absolutely this is a great time for anyone else that you have and so if you would just go ahead

[01:18:25] and uh call on someone to join us and then move us through uh each of the folks that you have here with you today okay great i have a list but also if i miss anybody please chime in so i'm going to invite dr martin first and then dr hall good afternoon my name is dr lisa martin i'm the superintendent of northampton county public schools we on the eastern shore are very excited about the opportunities to partner not only with odu and the eastern shore community college but with all of our space friends and are looking at as we roll out this aviation aerospace opportunity

[01:19:04] for our students we're looking at what the these partnerships these experiences these project-based learning opportunities and potential internships, mentorships, and apprenticeships will do for our students. We also recognize that the Eastern Shore, while narrow across, it is very long, and as this industry continues to expand, it is looking to move into the Northampton area. So we need to ensure that our students are prepared for the workforce, as well as to ensure economic development here in Northampton County. Thank you.

[01:19:38] it's great to see you here dr martin thank you hey thank you thank you and hi karen um hello i'm dr hall from akmack county public school as a superintendent and as dr martin said we're also excited about this new endeavor for akmack in northampton county and we look forward to working with um northampton county old dominion eastern shore community college as well as our partners

[01:20:13] also and um this lab school will enhance our current curriculum and provide our students with more opportunities to be workforce ready um in the area of aerospace and unmanned systems so we are excited also thank you thank you for being with us here today dr hall i know that you're a long long way away but virtual just brings you right here from akamak thanks for being with us welcome um so dr schaefer had a 130 that he had to log off but he told me to feel free to mention his support and the support of eastern shore community college but he um he was here for

[01:20:53] a bit and then he had to go to a meeting um so i would also like to invite um joyce winterton to um share uh can you hear me all right my camera does not want to turn on um i've got a new laptop and we're having a little challenge but really want to say how important i'm joyce winterton i'm part of the senior management team at nasa wallops flight facility and lead our education efforts we are very optimistic about expanding our work with both akamak and northampton county and our partners the aerospace industry on the eastern shore is clearly expanding we're having

[01:21:31] more opportunities to work with collaborators and partners our launch cadence is increasing significantly and this project is very critical and essential to our future workforce so the kinds of opportunities that we'll work with the team to provide both for students and our educators giving them real world hands-on experience at wallops flight facility is something we will expand and look forward to so it's really a very robust and needed program here on the eastern shore

[01:22:04] and nasa is very willing to expand what we do with eastern shore community college odu and the school districts so thank you thank you so much uh dr sanso is there anyone else that is here we do have a couple more yes i'm going to invite my colleagues from the virginia space grant consortium um dr white and um so i wasn't sure if you were speaking say chris i see chris's camera is off um so good afternoon i am dr rachel white the assistant director of the virginia space grant

[01:22:38] consortium and vsgc is a member of nasa's national space grant program we consist of five virginia universities videoe virginia community college system nasa langley research center nasa wallops flight facility and other members with a strong interest in aerospace and stem education workforce development and research vsgc provides free stem programs for students educators and researchers to build the stem pipeline for the state of virginia the virginia space current consortium supports the aerospace academy of the virginia of the eastern shore being led by olderman university

[01:23:16] and in the partnerships with Akamak and Northampton County Public Schools. VSGC secondary programs that significantly align with the mission and vision of the AAES include the Virginia Space Coast Scholars, Virginia Aerospace Science and Technology Scholars, and the Virginia Earth and System Science Scholars. All three programs focus on increasing students' aerospace-related STEM knowledge and curiosity. Through several online modules, students are encouraged to grow their creativity in designing new concepts in aerospace and the

[01:23:50] NASA-related missions. VSGC can identify spots for AAES students. And for professional development, we can provide educators training surrounding the aerospace sector, workforce needs, and career pathways into their classrooms teaching that can be leveraged to increase the AAES staff and partnering school division's content knowledge and skills. Two of these existing PD programs include bringing space into the cte classroom with odu and stem takes flight professional development at nasa wallops vsgc can offer spots in these workshops for aes staff and teachers in

[01:24:30] support of this lab school and lastly vsgc can provide experiential hands-on educational summer academy programs for students i will serve as our primary point of contact for the project i have previous experience in serving as the Administrative Director of a Virginia Governor STEM Academy, and we will involve program STEM coordinators to serve as subject matter experts in the field of aerospace education as appropriate. Thank you so much. Thank you. Thank you. Thanks. We also have Sydney McGee. Hello. Can everybody hear me okay? Yeah. Okay, great. Hi, I'm on the Eastern Shore,

[01:25:09] so you never quite know with our signal out here. I'm at the Space Court today. But hi, nice to see everyone i'm sydney mcgee i'm with the virginia spaceport authority i am the chief of education and intern development and we are so excited about the aerospace lab school about the aerospace academy of the eastern shore and funnily enough we actually have pretty strong partnerships already with their supporting institutions vsa was actually started by an odu professor and it also we've had an mou with escc for quite a while now for a few years now so this is actually a continuation of a partnership it doesn't feel like a brand new partnership even though this is

[01:25:46] a new endeavor so we're really excited to keep these partnerships going and to get these students access to our spaceport and to our launch pads we're just building our fourth right now so we have a lot of exciting growth and construction happening out here at the mid-atlantic regional spaceport and one of the main pillars of vsa that upholds us is furthering stem education in the commonwealth so this makes all the sense in the world to us and our customers as well such as rocket lab are really interested in recruiting talent from the shore and as they bring business and as they bring jobs here they want people who are from here to hire and employ in those jobs

[01:26:24] they don't want to move people from new zealand they don't want to have people from other states so we've heard that from rocket lab and other customers of ours so this just lines up in every conceivable way for us. So we're so excited and so happy to support and give access to these kids.

[01:26:39] Thank you so much. Thank you. Kim Cech? I feel like I'm calling a roster in my class. I just appreciate everybody being here. Yes. Hello, everyone. I'm Kim Cech, the Executive Director of the Virginia Space Flight Academy, also currently at Wallops Island with potentially body, cellular, and Wi-Fi service. So hopefully everyone can hear and see me okay. So here at Willops Island, we are a long-standing provider of STEM education with a very heavy aerospace

[01:27:16] lean in both Northampton and Acombeck County Public Schools. We are in full support of the aerospace academy on the eastern shore um we are in our 26th year of serving local students through our residential space camp that's operated at wallops island through a special space act agreement with the nasa wallops flight facility and also through our year-round stem academy program which focuses all on aerospace engineering computer sciences and physics topics as well

[01:27:55] Our curriculum is uniquely positioned to enhance the objectives outlined in the AAES proposal by offering lab school students with unparalleled access and seats at our space camp to continue their summer learning, as well as supporting students during the school year through our STEM Academy modules, which operate both fall, spring semesters, and also in the summer.

[01:28:23] All of these programs connect students to real-world applications and exposure to the diverse workforce, working in the industry both locally here at Wallops and throughout the state of Virginia. With your support of this proposal, we are very excited to kind of pull together what Sydney spoke to, the power of the existing partnerships here on the Eastern Shore within the Wallops aerospace ecosystem.

[01:28:55] um this crew will be able to provide students with a comprehensive aerospace education that really lead to local students pursuing careers within the state and locally here at wallace so thank you so much we're excited to be a part of this application process thank you and i think we have one more um christina brooks and if i'm incorrect please chime in after her thank you hi karen um just wanted i'm christina brooks with the hampton roads workforce council we are the workforce

[01:29:32] development board that serves go virginia region five and we do support efforts on the eastern shore in collaboration with our colleagues at the bay consortium workforce board as well we are very excited about this proposal we are on standby to help however we can and i just want to thank you so much for considering this application and we look forward to hopefully hearing uh the good news later on thank you thank you dr sances does that conclude um comments from from your support base that's here today i believe it does all right

[01:30:09] thank you it was wonderful to hear from each of you i'm now going to turn it over to dr andy armstrong who will present the staff report on the aerospace academy proposal thank you dr moran And committee members, I would like to again provide a brief overview on behalf of the Agency on the Aerospace Academy of the Eastern Shore, AAES, lab school application.

[01:30:35] AAES has proposed to create a pipeline to prepare workers for the aerospace and adjacent industries identified as priorities by the GO Virginia Region 5 Economic Development Authority as an innovative interdisciplinary school and the regional standard of excellence in preparation for the high-tech jobs in these high-growth fields.

[01:30:53] ODU and their partners, Eastern Shore Community College, Acomac County Public Schools, and Northampton County Public Schools, have presented a quality proposal that represents significant support and cooperation from among higher ed, K-12 public education, and as you can see today from the testimonials, a variety of industry and philanthropic partners present in the aerospace networks that continue to grow on the Eastern Shore of Virginia.

[01:31:16] This lab school proposal represents the beginning of an educational program that aspires to adapt to the needs of the aerospace industry and the unique communities of Acomac and Northampton Counties through support of K-12 students and responsiveness to workforce demands. Our review of the ODU AAES application has included multiple rounds of subject matter expert feedback and several calls before and since the submission of the application, as well as an on-site visit to the Eastern Shore in May, which included the Virginia Department of Education, Dr. Coons, as well as members of the governor's transformation team. The AAES team has been responsive and inquisitive as

[01:31:52] they have thoughtfully adjusted their plan to meet the compliance requirements of Virginia lab schools while leaving space for growth and future ambitions aligned with student success. As you will see in the attached completeness and compliance report for the purposes of our standing committee review today, the ODU AAES proposal is ready to implement in the elements of executive summary, mission, vision, educational program, governance, management structure, financial and operational information, placement plan, and other assurances and requirements.

[01:32:21] The ODU AAES is slated to begin operations with students in 2526, providing a year of startup activities to ensure a thoughtful and deliberate application of the proposed curriculum, facilities, and technology improvements in cultivation of emerging partnerships.

[01:32:37] Dr. Moran, I stand ready for any questions of the committee. Thank you very much, Dr. Armstrong. Excuse me. At this point, I would love to turn to Mr. Hanson see if you have any questions thank you dr moran and thank you um all and just uh dr sanzo great to see you again and um dr reed just appreciate the quality proposal that has come before the committee today and just uh really i'm very impressed both by the scope and the direction of the proposal and

[01:33:14] really the partnerships between education and business and the government funding and philanthropic it really is a total community effort so just commend you for that I really have one question and just with the kind of the student population of 50 freshmen first year maybe just help me understand a little bit if you know if you have a 10 attrition rate every year what is the continuity of the program for four years between the curriculum and the internships

[01:33:54] or apprenticeships and if um if you did have some attrition and fill in those seats for the middle of the classes is there just would students be behind in terms of the curriculum for the four years or maybe just help me understand how that would work yeah that's a good question and it's one that we've talked a little bit about and i feel like the way that we've designed the freshman year and having those two courses and then having the one as an option in the sophomore year allows if we have attrition that freshman for students to kind of catch up with an additional elective

[01:34:32] course and we can supplement with the with the english course as well and so that that to me has built in that freshman to sophomore also just honestly suspect that this is going to be a really popular program. And I feel like we may need to already anticipate having more seats that we may potentially need to add in that sophomore year. And so we've talked again with partners like the Virginia Space Flight Association and with the Virginia Space Grant Consortium. And I realize I'm probably getting names a little bit mixed up, but they're also available to help and present

[01:35:05] with those supplemental resources. The other piece is we have written in funding for students to attend that summer experience, but it doesn't necessarily mean that all freshmen have to attend that summer experience the summer after their freshman year. There are, it's written in where it could be potentially freshman or sophomore, depending upon the age for the students.

[01:35:31] I think too, that that's something that we are going to continue to discuss and explore, but I feel confident that at least the freshmen to sophomore, if we need to have more, is that mechanisms already built in um and then we we can definitely look at what that would look like from a junior to senior year or sophomore to junior junior or senior year with attrition thank you yeah thank you dr moran i don't have any other questions all right then i'm going to turn it to mr bailey just thank you thank you for just the creativity and the thoughtfulness and the

[01:36:08] comprehensiveness that went into the application uh super super exciting on a number of fronts i was really uh impressed too with the teacher preparation and just all the different ways that you're bringing some innovation in there with the apprenticeship model the residency model and just helping to not just strengthen your program but to strengthen uh hopefully our educator pipeline that can just go and be an amazing stem resource around the commonwealth uh i wondered if you could just elaborate a little bit more too on just the process of uh inviting students to participate you talked about how important it was for diversity and it listed a number of different sort of ways

[01:36:47] that you're thinking about diversity from racial and social economic and i just wondered if you could talk a little bit more about just how do you you go out and encourage students to consider a program like this some that might not think of themselves as a stem or as a space aerospace student and just how do you you go out and get their interested and then move them further into the the application process yes so that's a great question um i you know it is uh lunchtime conversations it is being embedded in the middle school it is being at the parent nights with the

[01:37:25] students in the middle in high school speaking to that attrition and adding more students in there it's um deep community outreach because part of it when you introduce a new program there's a big trust piece of it that's built into the components um one of one of our benefits with our other lab schools is we have experts in community and community outreach and engagement um and being able to work with with with that those faculty members and um working you know i can tell you working with northampton and akamak they know their students and their families very well um

[01:38:00] it's not a type of initiative where i think it's going to be emails you know it is really going to be at embedded in the community speaking to it field trips looking at the ways that we can potentially work with our partners at the middle school level and having site-based trips out to wallops island already out to other partners going out on site and letting kids get immersed in that work and so that they can see themselves as a part of it currently we don't have a go tech lab on the eastern shore christina can correct me if i'm wrong i think one of our hopes would

[01:38:37] be to get the go tech labs potentially out in northampton and akamak that's a middle school career and technology and emerging careers program so students are able to get their hands on the equipment so that they can see themselves in those careers because unless they understand and see and experience it then why would they go into that program let me let me speak one piece so that is is why we have a director and then we have an ed specialist written into that for the for the first year coming up because we need people who are on the ground who are engaging with our partners and again as I said Acomac and Northampton have talked about the ways in which we can reach out to the

[01:39:15] communities and they've already done that as a part of the initial planning for this grant but continuing to be out there because we would want to start recruiting students in December January as we think about scheduling and as I mentioned the scheduling piece is going to be a component that we have to consider and it's an open lottery and we could have you know x number of students here at this high school x students number of here so that we're able to thoughtfully sit down spring 2025 and think about what are the logistics how are we going to make this work how do we ensure that kids are connected and it's a cohort and they are a part of this community as they go

[01:39:47] through their four years that's great thank you so much really exciting to visit yeah thanks thank you thank you mr bailey do you have any further questions okay thank you i have just a couple before we move on to the next step with this proposal.

[01:40:07] And one is that I would love to hear just a little bit more about how you see your relationship with Eastern Shore building out. I am so thrilled to have seen so many community colleges either in partnership or bringing forward proposals around lab schools.

[01:40:24] And I know that the president was not able to stay with us today, but could you elaborate a little bit on that. In particular, since I think that you're intending to use some focus on their teacher education program at the community college to articulate with ODU in this project.

[01:40:44] I'd be happy to speak to that point. We've met already with Dr. Schaefer and his team at Eastern Shore several months ago to talk about this opportunity to be able to stand up a regional apprenticeship program. We've also spoken with our peers at Tidewater Community College to the extent that they offer some supplemental courses when not available at Eastern Shore, and we have the support of both. And so looking at supporting those paraprofessionals who might have taken their parapro assessment, but don't

have 60 credits completed toward their associate's degree to be able to complete those associates or start and complete an associate's degree through Eastern

[01:41:21] Shore. As you can imagine, I know you can appreciate that our focus is trying to remove the barriers of cost and time and travel and so being able to provide high quality teacher preparation programs at Eastern Shore Community College on-site, online at Tidewater Community College to support that, and then online strong teacher education at ODU. Again, we're able to drive to them and to support and provide classroom-based supports but to minimize the cost and travel for those individuals who are already working a full-time job in that region absolutely and then this question it goes along with a little bit of what you were just

[01:41:58] saying um and it is relevant for me to both students and to potential pre-service teachers that might be working in this program and that is do you anticipate that there are transportation barriers that you're going to have to address i know that tangier certainly offers some challenges to get kids uh to a place where they can participate in some of the activities you're describing, but also being able to get some of your ODU students into the pipeline to participate in practicum experiences out there, et cetera. I'd be happy to speak to the pre-service piece

[01:42:36] of it. So we've already been planning a tour of the Hampton Roads region. We recognize that some of our students currently enrolled at ODU see any bridge or tunnel as one too far to get to divisions. and so starting that conversation about how we can bring our pre-service students to our community partners to get a sense of the the great work that's being done in their schools we have already had a practice of providing the odu shuttle to provide transportation for those students who need extra supports to be able to get onto their k-12 campuses and we anticipate being able to continue doing that work we also really look to having a cohort model to support that work

[01:43:15] and continuity. We want to make sure that we reduce any kind of barrier, and that includes cost of licensure tests, test registration fees, the cost of tuition, looking at reductions in tuition at the undergraduate level, as well as things like transportation. Okay, and I don't know if Dr. Martin or Dr. Hall, if you're anticipating that transportation is going to create any challenges for you for students to participate for students absolutely not because we um dr hall and

[01:43:51] i work together very collaboratively on even when we're looking at taking students the away from us across across the water we're looking at what can we do to streamline and make sure that we have that partnership in transportation for our student interns or practicum students those that are going to be coming over here in particular for our student residents and our student apprenticeships we're hoping to grow those that are already here from the shore and enhance those partnerships but also one of the things that we did put in place um and northampton is we put a ride share program in and so if there's space available that would be something that we would explore to ensure

[01:44:29] that those teacher apprenticeships coming across could make sure that it's not a bridge too far in order to be a part of our school system so thank you it is it is one of the most beautiful wonderful areas of virginia and i would see it as a wonderful destination for educators uh to come that direction if they're not already there in the pipeline uh absolutely yeah dr hall well as far as our students coming from tangier because you did mention that yeah we already have systems in place to transform our students um to involve them in programs that are already here um in

[01:45:08] Akamai county so we already have those systems in place and we would just continue supporting them that way thank you you may be the only superintendent in virginia who has to take uh either air or water transportation to get to a school i do exactly right so thank you all right are there any other further questions from uh uh members of the committee if not is there a motion to approve the ODU University application on first and final review and refer to the Virginia State Board of

[01:45:46] Education for approval? I will move. Is there a second? I second. All right. Call for the vote. Aye. Aye. Any opposed? The ayes have it. So we had a 3-0 vote and I would like to say now that I just so appreciate you bringing this forward. We have been thrilled with every application that's

[01:46:21] come to us over the course of this past year and on behalf of the committee I'm going to direct you to post staff to post the Norfolk State University's application for 10-day public comment in accordance with the Standing Committee's procedures, compile the comments received for review by the State Board of Education in June, and direct staff to finalize a report with the Standing Committee's comments from today and endorsement and to compile that report along with the application and all additional material received by the standing committee and refer it to

[01:46:56] the board of education's june meeting at this time i'm going to return the gavel to chair wadiska to conclude our remaining business items and i just want to end by thanking everyone that is here from odu and from the eastern shore today from the school divisions for your time and for your commitment to this project thank you and uh this application will move forward thank you really appreciate everybody's time and and on this and i and i do want to express my thanks to the partners

[01:47:31] for their work i mean i think it's just going to be powerful for students so thank you it's really wonderful thank you very much dr sanzo for bringing the team together and for uh another odu uh proposal moving forward thank you all right thank you dr mariam thank you this time we're going to proceed with item c uh before we begin item c which is our pipeline update i'm actually going to go to the vice president of the state board of education mr hansen for an update from the

[01:48:03] state board of ed thank you madam chair um just a quick review the state board of education had a special meeting a couple weeks ago on may 21st and the prior recommendations from this committee were approved at that meeting our next meeting is next week on the 20th and 21st thursday and friday we do have a meeting in july as well but i think just in terms of the relevance for this

[01:48:40] committee with the state legislative actions that will bring the funding in some respects and decisions to a conclusion by the end of june there's gonna need to be i think obviously continued communication on our work as a committee for future proposals that will be coming our way and but also just the board is going to be making the

[01:49:15] financial decisions as we kind of come around to the end of the month with all of the modifications and subsequent recommendations that will be before us so that is it thank you mr hansom at this time then we'll go to dr armstrong for the pipeline update the pipeline update has been shared in advance with the committee members dr armstrong thank you madam chair

[01:49:52] and i am bringing up the update uh now i always struggle with this for some reason i think it's the move from teams to zoom all right here we go madam chair are we seeing that okay great thank you. Madam Chair and committee members, I would like to provide you all with an update on our lab school pipeline. As we all know, the 75 million dollars in lab school grant funds are required to be obligated in

about 20 days on June 30th. And as we review the pipeline, I would like to note, however, that the lab school grant fund sunset does not represent the end of the agency and

[01:50:31] committee's work. We will continue to accept and review lab school applications per statute while expanding our work to support those approved lab schools that will become operational in the fall of 24 and 25 and i'll share more about that in the next presentation about our innovation networks as of mid-may 12 approved contracted lab schools represented about 64 and a half million dollars in obligated planning grants startup and operational awards leaving about 10 and a half million dollars in the lab school grant fund funding awards are still pending for boe approved lab schools at ODU Suffolk and George Mason University Frederick as a result of action

[01:51:10] taken at the May Board of Education meeting, which Mr. Hanson referred to. Those lab schools along with any approved as a result of today's standing committee action will be finalized in the weeks ahead in collaboration with the Superintendent of Public Instruction and the Board President.

[01:51:26] I think this is an appropriate time when we look at this graphic just to thank everyone who has been part of the work to achieve board approval of 14 lab schools in the past 11 months. I would especially like to thank the standing committee for their time, their dedication.

[01:51:44] As we learned early on from IALS, there are fewer than 200 lab schools on the planet, and the Commonwealth is slated to become home to nearly a full 10 percent of the lab schools in the world, representing, of course, seven of the eight superintendent regions here in the Commonwealth.

[01:52:03] And we will keep the committee apprised as we complete the work related to the grant fund in the weeks ahead and on our progress toward implementation of these approved lab schools. But I do want to leave that up for a moment and just see if there are any questions. I have taken this and simplified it significantly now that we are here at the end of the grant fund to reflect those lab schools that have been approved and are still currently in the pipeline.

[01:52:31] Andy, I just want to go on record thanking you and your team for just your incredible work with each of the applicants and the recipients here and also those that are still in the pipeline. And just I think to your point earlier, the real work is really just now beginning on the implementation and execution of these schools.

[01:52:58] just thank you and especially you know these last month or two with all the disruption I really appreciate your leadership and that of the team. Thank you Mr. Hanson I couldn't do it without the support of the standing committee and everyone in the agency this is this has touched every office in the agency everything from the planning grant review committee to finance to innovation to early childhood instruction accountability exceptional education everybody so I do want to make sure I give all of the credit to the folks who have served as subject matter experts and

[01:53:35] have really kept the wheels turning on this. It has been quite an endeavor, and we're really excited for it. I do want to give one more note for the benefit of the committee, if you hadn't noticed this, and the requirements that became part of that budget language does require annual reporting to the governor, the House Appropriations, and Senate Finance Committees on the progress of our lab schools toward full financial sustainability upon the end of our lab school grant fund spending window, which is typically four years. The agency and this committee, we have elevated the scrutiny

[01:54:11] of lab school sustainability, and this requirement really further underscores the scrutiny on an ongoing basis, and we'll be working to ensure that all of our lab schools, as Ms. Wadiske and I have discussed throughout the year, are standing and effective well beyond when we're part of this process and uh so we look forward to to keeping the governor and those committees updated on sustainability and again i'm happy to answer any questions on our pipeline and i want to just thank you all for your service on behalf of the thousands of students who are going to realize opportunities that would not have otherwise been available because of the work that we have done for for

[01:54:47] lab schools thank you dr armstrong on behalf of the committee i well first i want to thank the state board for inviting us to be part of this incredible work um this has been a really rigorous and thorough process um the the staff um you have done an amazing job dr armstrong and i know that it's a very large team of individuals just as you noted part of the process that the committee

[01:55:20] developed was intentional that it would be thorough and why given the breadth of individuals that must be involved to set up the school we knew that that would touch numerous experts at the virginia department of education and they would need to be involved in the oversight and to ensure compliance and quality of programs and so dr armstrong i know that every month we say thank you but as we're coming to the end of the fiscal year i know that you'll express our

[01:55:54] gratitude to the entire subject matter review team as well as the planning grant team um i know behind the scenes it has been countless hours i started to pull a page number and it is in the thousands and thousands of pages that have been reviewed written and each of those has taken a tremendous amount of time so it's not only yourself and claire uh deb love susan williams mr chapman

[01:56:27] miss vaneski who's on this meeting as well all of you have just modeled exceptional professionalism and partnership with the applicants and have just been exemplars in the collaboration that's possible between state partners and community partners and so i want to thank you for the way that you approach the work with grace and dignity to the applicants and support for them. So thank you and thank you for the support you've provided us. Thank you all very much and I do want to also just thank Dr. Koons for her support as well of all of our work. You know we've had to shift

[01:57:05] priorities on several different occasions around this this year and I know we have all come together to get this done. So thanks everybody. Well that's an awesome report. Since you have the floor so to speak if you continue on on item d which is the innovation network and this is the next stage of the work which is ensuring support for the community that has been initiated here in the commonwealth yes uh and you may even say that this work could potentially be even even more

[01:57:41] challenging um as we move forward i'm sorry is this presentation visible to everybody it's a little small I know I let me see what I can do for you here okay as I fumble through let's do this that's good is that better okay great um madam chair and committee members as mentioned in the previous presentation while the agency continues to finalize outstanding applications and contracts on behalf of lab school applicants our attention is simultaneously shifting and has been to the

[01:58:21] support of our school year 24 and 25 lab school implementation and growth of our Virginia Innovation Network. Support for implementation will come in the form of in-person convenings, provision of day one kits, day one ready kits for our schools, especially those coming online this fall, organization of thematic networks, on-demand support, and scheduled at least monthly calls, formalized

calls with all lab schools but of course we remain available on a on-demand basis for everybody and with priority of course for those lab schools that are coming online with

[01:58:56] students here in 2024. Currently we anticipate seven of of our 14 approved lab schools will begin operations in the fall 2024 with students including VCU which is already operational the UMW ATI Lab School, Germanna's FEA, Emory & Henry Southwest Virginia Heels, the James Madison University Lab School for Career Exploration, George Mason Frederick's Data Science Lab School, and Roanoke College. And as the committee knows, each of these programs is unique with varying levels of direct interconnectedness with partner school divisions. Much of the work of this phase

[01:59:35] of support in the months ahead will be to provide proper guidance to ensure compliance with K-12 operational requirements as prescribed in the SOQs, which all the nuts and bolts, I think, that if you have been working in K-12, you assume these things. You don't have to think too much about them. But if you are a higher ed partner, whether private two-year or four-year public, a lot of those nuts and bolts may not be readily apparent. So we're going to really lean in to ensure that all of those schools have the baseline knowledge around enrollment and finance

[02:00:10] human resources, exceptional education, and are beginning to populate that with those schools now. So we'll be heading into that headlong in the weeks ahead. We'll convene our 2024 lab schools in the month ahead in an in-person format. We were hoping to have this done already in full transparency. However, as Mr. Hansen mentioned, we've had to do a bit of pivoting in some of our work, but we're looking forward to dedicating our attention to this in the weeks ahead. So An in-person convening, perhaps virtual, with our 2024 lab schools, followed by frequent consults and individual check-ins that lead up to the start of school.

[02:00:50] And I'm also especially excited to be there to celebrate when our lab schools kick off and to really get the word out about this work and to make a big splash on behalf of the lab schools in the media as well. This details just many of the compliance aspects of each of the phases of our support through opening.

[02:01:10] We really look at the focus areas there, as you can see right now, going into just hiring facilities, the governing board selection. A lot of this has been done at this point, but we do want to check with everybody before the end of June to make sure we're where we need to be. And then we'll move into some of those more technical aspects around transportation, food service, DOE reporting.

[02:01:31] We're working right now to set everybody up on SWSS. I want to, again, another department, our data research technology department with Susan Williams and Carol Bozicci, who have already helped to develop that. And then phase three will be opening and going live, talking about media engagement, start of school requirements, attendance, and then performance evaluations and just operational fidelity for our lab schools as they really hit the ground running this fall.

[02:01:56] So as a quick overview, we'll have our day one kit finalized by the end of this month. We'll establish our weekly launch check-ins for all of these fall 2024 lab schools. We'll have our 24 lab school summit in the next month before the middle of July.

[02:02:14] And then we'll have one site visits to everybody before the end of August when most of these will be opening anyway. So we'll continue as well to support sustainability and activating business and industry partners, working with the secretary's office on that as well. And then making sure we're not

neglecting the needs of these 2025 lab schools who, before we know it, will be sitting here next year at the same time, and they'll be getting ready to mobilize to begin operations with students for their start in 2025.

[02:02:42] So that work will continue in the background as well. And this will be a big lift moving forward, but we will keep the standing committee updated with progress and continue to provide all the support we can to all of our lab schools. Thank you, Dr. Armstrong. Any questions from committee members?

[02:03:02] I would love to just make a couple of comments. One is that I'm really appreciative of seeing the layout of the 24-25 plan for the lab schools that have been approved and moving those forward.

[02:03:20] When I'm looking at not just being sort of day one ready, but also looking at year five ready, Dr. Armstrong, some things that I've been thinking about is how does this work, not just sit inside the organizations that have come together to support these up, to get them implemented, that I also am critically interested in, how do we come away from these lab school

[02:03:52] experiences with findings and opportunities to inform changes inside the public education structure that exists in our comprehensive high schools, middle schools, and elementary schools. I had this vision the other night. I thought, wow, I would love to be able to attend a year from now a summit where the first year of the lab schools come together and run a conference for other schools in Virginia that are interested in knowing more about how do you get these kinds of programs started inside your high schools. I wouldn't expect everybody to need to get a lab

[02:04:31] school designation to do that. I would like to think the lab schools give us the data we need to suggest how do other schools begin to adopt and adapt some of the work the lab schools are doing. I also would love to see every year almost a website that is transparent that shows kind of in a dashboard kind of model, and I know that you all have been working on this dashboard concept, How are the lab schools progressing towards meeting their goals?

[02:05:05] And one of those being sustainability, in terms of financial sustainability, how are they doing so that other schools in Virginia, in the nation, the public can all get insights into how these schools are really changing the way that we think about what's possible inside public education?

[02:05:25] So I just, you know, I'd love to see a plan for that amidst everything else. Well, and Dr. Brand, thank you. I'm going to take that and transcribe what you just said, because these are lab schools. They should develop practice that should serve as exemplar for what's happening across K-12. And the fact that we're leveraging resources that, again, we've talked about this before. We have public education in Virginia operates in 131 separate school divisions. The fact that we're connecting divisions, we're connecting them with higher ed

[02:06:01] resources, with business partners, just has to be the next natural step to ensure that K-12 adapts to what the needs are in the workplace and what the needs are just for the future. I think a lot of it is going to be, just as you said, celebrating this work, publicizing it. We will need a dedicated public relations aspect to what we're doing to get the word out, to engage not just those who are already in the network of lab schools, but to engage every school division. That may be through working through established networks, through VSBA, VAS, other networks that are already have

[02:06:40] captive audiences really with K-12 divisions to share the results of what we're doing, to share how it happens, and then what we can do to help them in creating this. And you hope that eventually goals, this becomes the rule rather than the exception, right, is the way that we're operating these lab

schools. But yes, I really appreciate that question. And as soon as we can take a breath from the applications here, we're going to dedicate our work toward that next stage of really making this something that's going to be integrated into what we do every day.

[02:07:14] And just thank you, you, the rest of the staff in the department. You took on something I don't think that you were thought when you signed on to the job, this was going to be in your portfolio, but there is nothing that's a more important portfolio for public education than its innovation portfolio, because that's where we're going to fuel the future of learning for our young people.

[02:07:35] And I just appreciate that everyone has provided such incredible support to get these lab school applications in front of us as a committee, and then for the ones that have moved on to the state board to do the same for the board. So thank you and your team. I will heartily agree with everything that Dr. Moran has indicated. I think one of the things that's been so incredibly exciting about the work has been the R&D potential here. You know, when we think about lab schools, when the International Association of Lab Schools came to speak with us, there were really kind of three

[02:08:11] legs to the stool. There was first, deeper, broader options for young people. The second was very intentional professional development and innovative pre-service models for teachers. And then the third was sharing that information and the research out with the broader education community to inform the practice at large.

[02:08:34] And so I think you'll hear a frequent refrain from us of, you know, how are we doing on those three legs of the school and are all three being nurtured along the way. One item that I'm just going to kind of resurface at this time that I think might be a modest step but hopefully an easy one that could be made um you know in virginia the virginia department of education and then we have chefs and one of the things that has occurred to me through our

[02:09:04] conversations would be having more intentional connections between this work and chef and the benefit being that uh you know the high ground institutions are the partner now in the lab schools they are the lead partner and as we're thinking about what we learned through this work about teacher pre-service and professional development in service you know pd those types of things you know those lessons learned those will be most applicable to our teacher colleges

[02:09:44] and so i just wonder now i see dr coons is on so sorry dr coons i didn't i didn't see you on the board earlier otherwise i would have obviously thanked you um but that might be a nice leadership fit uh to make those connections and it it's not always been uh structurally how things work in the state but the wonderful thing about lab schools is that it does create partnerships opportunities to refresh conversations and maybe that would this could could be one of those so if in future updates do you think about how to have those connections with chev and i know that they're going through a leadership transition and i had worked with the old executive director not

[02:10:24] the old sorry the previous executive director and certainly would look forward to working with the new one but um dr coons i don't know is there would you like to say something about that or you can leave it with dr armstrong i don't mean to call on you unprompted but that's okay i think that's a good call i know um the deputy secretary of education emily engolikson is also on the call so that is something we can take and talk about um she has been an amazing shepherd in this work as well so um and working with the higher ed and behind the scenes really making those connections but we can definitely work on an update for this group we'd be happy to do that and the new head of

[02:11:04] shev worked with me in three different capacities previously we're very fortunate to have him on board and i know he's worked with john as well in the past awesome and dr armstrong this won't surprise you uh but just for the good of the order publicly there has been definitely some interest in lab committee members at some point late fall winter um going out and visiting at schools having worked for the school divisions i know that the first day first month first six weeks

[02:11:39] that is not a good time for visitors but when the time is right and it would be beneficial there's definitely interest and curiosity and excitement um to have an opportunity to go and visit some of the schools so i'll just file that i will work to to secure a van and we can just make a road trip to see some lab schools that would be wonderful all right let's with no further discussion on item d let's move to item b i'll kind of bring this one up the last time we met we have meetings scheduled ironically enough for labor day in september

[02:12:18] as well as October and November. I certainly don't intend, as much as I enjoy working with all of you, I don't intend to meet with you on Labor Day, and I'm thinking that we may not need necessarily October or November. And so I was going to propose to the committee that maybe we should remove September and November.

[02:12:36] We would retain the October meeting. The caveat on this would be if at any point an applicant comes forward that we need to consider, such as Norfolk State, of course, we can convene a meeting. But in terms of our published schedule of planned meetings, I thought October might be a nice time frame post-start of school so that we could receive an update from Dr. Armstrong on enrollment, how the process went, those types of things.

[02:13:09] But I did want to open this one up for discussion and get the feedback from the committee members, and then we can decide how best to proceed. think it makes perfect sense and just be flexible if we do have some items pop out yeah nothing to elaborate on i would say the same thing makes sense and you know we're all flexible as uh situation changes as well so i would concur okay thank you for that input committee members um

[02:13:48] is there a motion then to update or revise our schedule to remove the september and november meeting so moved second is there a second second mine was on the second okay all those in favor of the motion please signify by stating aye aye chair votes aye as well any opposed indicate by stating nay the motion carries four to zero thank you very much at this time we'll move to the discussion of current issues are there any other items for the good of the order to discuss today i see no or

[02:14:25] head shakes so i'm going to proceed is there any public comment on non-agenda items dr armstrong no ma'am thank you sir all right without further ado we are adjourned and we look forward to seeing you all later this fall thank you so much and enjoy the rest of your summer thanks everybody thank you for your work as chair you have led us uh beautifully to today so thank you very much for the work that you've done thank you dr man thank you bye guys thanks everybody



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